It Really Happened

A Thought on Parashat Lech Lecha

Dvar Torah - a printable page



Dear children, the parasha tells us that Avraham and Lot had so much livestock and so many possessions that it became hard for them to stay together. After a quarrel broke out between their shepherds, they decided to part ways, each going his own way. Lot sees Sodom, the beautiful place, and chooses it. Everyone knows that wicked people live in Sodom, but that doesn't stop Lot from going there.

Avraham Avinu also comes to a moment in the parasha when he has to make a decision. After Avraham fights the four great kings and defeats them, the king of Sodom thanks him and wants to give him riches. But Avraham doesn't want to take anything for himself, because he doesn't want the king of Sodom to think that he was the one who helped Avraham and made him rich. Avraham wants to receive straight from Hashem. He doesn't go by what looks beautiful or by what he desires, but by what is right to do.

We can learn a very big lesson from this: every day we have many choices, some more important and some less. When we face a choice like that, we can choose what is comfortable and what we are used to, but if we want, we can choose differently. We can make decisions like Avraham Avinu, out of faith and a wish to live in a way that is right and true. To choose truth over imagination. To choose growing closer to Hashem over a passing desire.

Shabbat Shalom, and a blessed one!